unemployment 8, 18, 19, 21, 30, 32–3, 34, 37, 43 *see also* jobs
United Nations 15, 101; Declaration of Human Rights 211
United States 4, 5, 8, 11, 14–15, 24, 29, 33, 39, 40, 62, 63, 64, 65, 67, 76, 79, 94, 96, 99–100, 103–4, 106, 107, 108, 113, 114, 115, 118, 119, 120, 121, 127, 130, 131, 133, 135, 136, 142, 145, 147, 150–1, 152, 159, 161, 162, 165, 168, 169, 172, 173, 175, 177, 178, 182, 185, 191, 194, 200, 219, 227, 230, 231, 236, 242, 275
Universal Basic Income (UBI) 37–43
universe, age of 274
university, deciding what to study at 54–5
University of Oxford 310
US Air Force (USAF) 29, 30
useless class 18, 30, 32, 121
US National Highway Traffic Safety Administration 24
US presidential election: (1964) 113, 114; (2016) 8, 85

Vedas 127, 131, 132, 198, 235, 240, 298
Victoria, Queen 15, 178
Vietnam 14, 100, 104, 176, 285
Vietnam War (1955–75) 62, 63, 100, 172, 173
violence: ethics and 200–2; nationalism and 112; number of deaths attributed to 16, 114; terrorism and *see* terrorism; war and *see* war
Vipassana meditation 310, 312, 315–16
Vishwamitra 181

Wahhabism 137
Waksman, Selman 194
Walt Disney Pictures 249–51, 267, 270
war xi, xiii, 138, 170, 171–80; AI and 61–8, 123–4; economy and 177–9; possibility
of 123–4, 138, 170, 171–80; religion and 138; spreads ideas, technology and people 99–100; stupidity/folly and 179–80; successful wars, decline in number of 171–80; technological disruption increases likelihood of 123–4
Warmland (fictional nation) 148–50, 152–4
War on Terror 168
Watson (IBM computer system) 20–1
weapons 123, 136, 212, 224–5; autonomous weapons systems 63; nuclear 14, 34, 107–8, 112–15, 116, 119, 121, 122, 123, 124, 137, 138, 154, 165, 167–70, 178, 179, 181; terrorism and *see* terrorism; weapons of mass destruction xiv, 167–70
welfare state xii, 10–11, 76
West Bank 64–5, 224